

music and the lively jitterbug dance style was introduced. The year 1937 ushered in the Andrews Sisters, who enjoyed their greatest success during the 1937–1942 years of stock market correction (“girl groups” were also popular in 1959–1962, another time the stock market underwent a correction).

Movies appear to be linked with trends in the stock market. . . . In the early 'Thirties, as the Dow Jones Industrials collapsed, horror movies descended upon the American scene.

The early to mid-'Forties featured uptempo big band music, which held sway until the market peaked in 1945–46. A late-1940's stock market correction then unfolded, and mellow love-ballad crooners, both male and female, came into style. Even jazz experienced a dramatic slowdown as “cool jazz” took over in 1949, the year of a major low for stocks.

The post-war bull market's initial advance from 1949 through 1953 was accompanied by the mass appearance of new grassroots-style band music on the charts. During that span, 49 Country and Western music titles sold over a million copies each and “race” music sold strongly enough to require its own sales charts in the industry's trade magazines. By 1954, the emerging excitement of an improving public mood, as reflected by the rising stock market, could no longer be contained. The folk band styles of music began to emerge, and high-energy rock 'n' roll exploded on the scene.

Within a few years, the trendsetters were jitterbugging like crazy to work off their collective emotional high. The energetic, positive sentiment proved only a warm-up for the euphoric joy expressed by the melodic, harmonic music of the “British Invasion” and American fun bands. These